

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT
POLICY MANUAL
VOLUME 6

Policy: 600.05 Accountability System

11/2023

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The purpose of this guideline is to provide a citywide standard for tracking and accounting for Fire Department Personnel on emergency incidents involving potential structural collapse or where an IDLH atmosphere exists.

This guideline covers the responsibilities and expectations of the Fire Department Personnel to establish and implement this accountability system.

RESPONSIBILITIES

It shall be the responsibility of the Incident Commander to ensure the establishment and implementation of the accountability system. Each person involved in an incident whether at the strategic, tactical, or task level of an incident must make a strong personal commitment to follow all policies and procedures regarding accountability.

DEFINITIONS

PASS TAG ACCOUNTABILITY SYSTEM: A procedure that utilizes Apparatus Tags, Personnel Tags, and an Accountability Board to track the assignment and location of fire department personnel operating at an emergency incident.

ACCOUNTABILITY BOARD: A status I command board utilized to track and account for fire department personnel.

APPARATUS TAG: Plastic tag with 3 letter agency designator and unit radio designator (i.e. CHO E61).

PERSONNEL TAG: Plastic tag with fire department members first initial and last name.

PASS TAG: Apparatus Tag affixed with the Personnel Tags for the assigned members of the apparatus.

ACCOUNTABILITY COLLECTION POINT: A location designated by the first arriving Company Officer during their report on conditions where Pass Tag's are collected.

HELMET MAGNETS: A set of magnets with the unit designator that is attached to the fire helmet magnet panels. At all times these magnets shall reflect the member's current apparatus assignment.

IMMEDIATELY DANGEROUS TO LIFE OR HEALTH (IDLH): An atmosphere that poses an immediate threat to life, would cause irreversible adverse health effects, or would impair and individual's ability to escape from a dangerous atmosphere.

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PERSONNEL ACCOUNTABILITY REPORT (PAR): PAR is the process of conducting a head count of units and personnel operating on the fire ground. The respective dispatch center will start an "Incident Clock" with the report of a working structure fire or as a result of the size up by the first arriving company reporting a working fire. The dispatch center shall inform the Incident Commander every 15 minutes of the elapsed incident time. A PAR shall be conducted every 15 minutes at all working structure fires or at the discretion of the Incident Commander.

ACCOUNTABILITY SYSTEM COMPONENTS

To enhance accountability and to improve tracking of personnel on emergency incidents the Pass Tag System will be used. The Pass Tag Systems is comprised of three components:

- a. Personnel Tag
- b. Apparatus Tag
- c. Accountability / Command Board

Each Fire Department Member is assigned four Personnel Tags. Each tag is imprinted with first initial and last name, i.e. J. Green. The Personnel Tags will be stored with Velcro under the rear brim of the structure helmet. When assigned to an apparatus the personnel tag will be affixed to the corresponding Apparatus Tag.

Each apparatus will have an Apparatus Tag imprinted with the OES three-letter agency identifier and radio unit designator. The Apparatus Tag will be affixed with Velcro in plain sight within the interior of the apparatus cab.

Each apparatus will have an Accountability/Command Board. This board will be affixed with Velcro in plain sight within the interior of the apparatus cab.

ACCOUNTABILITY SYSTEM IMPLEMENTATION

It shall be the responsibility of the Company Officer to ensure the Pass Tag reflects the members assigned to the apparatus at all times. In the event of a personnel change the Company Officer shall update the Pass Tag accordingly.

It shall be the responsibility of the Company Officer to ensure that each member on the apparatus has the correct helmet magnets reflecting the current apparatus assignment.

The Pass Tag accountability system shall be expanded and contracted to accommodate all assigned fire personnel and equipment operating at the incident.

This shall be under the control and responsibility of the Incident Commander.

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PASS TAG SYSTEM ON EMERGENCY INCIDENTS

The initial arriving Company Officer during the report on conditions will communicate the Accountability Collection Point for the incident. Typically the collection point will be inside the cab of the first arriving apparatus, unless the incident dictates otherwise.

The Incident Commander can delegate an Accountability Officer for the incident.

The Accountability Officer will work closely with the Incident Commander, Operations, and Division/Group Supervisors to track and maintain accurate accountability for all personnel operating at the emergency incident.

Incidents involving large commercial and wide rise buildings may require the use of multiple Accountability Collection Points. Division/Group Supervisors shall work closely with the Accountability Officer to track members.

If it is not feasible to drop off the Pass Tag at the Accountability Collection Point, the Company Officer will communicate their location, assignment and number of personnel to the Incident Commander. Example: "Truck 1 will be operating on the C side of the structure, assigned to ventilation, going to the roof with four."

Before leaving the incident, company officers will be responsible for picking up their Pass Tags and placing them back on their assigned apparatus.

PERSONNEL ACCOUNTABILITY REPORT (PAR)

A PAR will be required but not limited to the following situations:

- a. Every 10 minutes during interior structural fire attack
- b. Any report of a missing or trapped firefighter.
- c. Any change in strategy from offensive to defensive.
- d. Any sudden unexpected incident event (building collapse, explosion etc.)

In the event a Company Officer cannot account for a Fire Department Member, he/she shall declare **MAYDAY/FIREFIGHTER DOWN** - all crewmembers are not accounted for.

PERSONNEL TAG

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Made from rigid plastic, size is W' x 1" with Velcro on the backside. First initial and last name. Arial: font size 12. *(If necessary utilize the first and middle initials to differentiate personnel with duplicate names)*

Recommended colors:

Chief Officers: Gold with Black Letters

Fire Captain: Red with White Letters

Engineer: Yellow with Red Letters

Firefighter: White with Black Letters

APPARATUS TAG

Made from rigid plastic, size 1"x 3", with Velcro on the front and backside. Agency and Radio Identifier on the top of the tag, Arial: font size 18. Color is black with white lettering for BLS units and blue with white lettering for ALS units.

ACCOUNTABILITY BOARD

Made from clipboard type material, size is 8 "x 11", with Velcro on the front side to receive Pass Tags. Top of board is for incident information, can utilize grease pencil to write information on the board.